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Linguistic Tricks: A Semantic Inventory

Status: Working, source-backed inventory
Scope: Linguistic mechanisms discussed in the private source-development material; source filenames and links are withheld from this publication
Purpose: A component of the reality-anchored, truth-seeking epistemic constitution described in 0010-culture-mechanics.semantic and 0020-epistemic-agency.semantic-definition.md

Within *Culture Program Ecology*, these mechanisms can help Culture Programs conceal conflict, protect load-bearing claims from defeat, attack rivals, or simulate public correction. Their presence is diagnostic evidence, not by itself proof that a program is Pure-Ideology or that the speaker intended deception.

1. Working concept

The reviewed source material uses *linguistic tricks* as a practical name for sophisticated forms of lying and truth-obscuring speech. The best analytical umbrella recovered during source development is **instrumental untruthfulness** (*instrumentelle Unwahrhaftigkeit*): communication governed primarily by the effect it is meant to produce rather than by truth, accuracy, sincerity, shared meaning, or reasonable resolution of disagreement.

This inventory therefore uses *lie* in a broad normative sense. An utterance need not contain a literally false sentence to belong here. It can mislead by omission, implication, presupposition, redefinition, framing, diversion, attribution, contextual manipulation, or corruption of the dialogue itself.

The family resemblance is:

A linguistic trick subordinates one or more truth-supporting conditions of communication to operative effectiveness while preserving enough of the appearance of communication to steer an audience.

This is not a claim that every use of rhetoric, framing, conceptual innovation, ambiguity, or a fallacious argument is intentionally deceptive. The classifications below concern their manipulative uses.

Sophism and sophistry

Sophism is an important established name for a large subset of what this inventory calls linguistic tricks. A sophism is an argument that appears rational or valid but owes its persuasive force to a concealed ambiguity, invalid inference,

misrepresentation, irrelevant consideration, or comparable defect that obstructs truth-seeking. **Sophistry** is the practice or style of constructing and deploying such arguments.

The terms are related but not interchangeable:

- A **fallacy** is a defect in reasoning and can be committed accidentally.
- A **sophism** is an apparently plausible, argument-shaped maneuver whose defect is concealed or exploited; the term ordinarily carries a stronger implication of strategic or intellectually dishonest use.
- **Sophistry** is the systematic practice of producing, combining, or habitually relying on sophisms.
- A **linguistic trick** is broader. It also includes non-argumentative operations such as omission, euphemistic inversion, defamatory labeling, dog-whistle messaging, information flooding, and source manipulation.
- **Instrumental untruthfulness** is broader still: it is the governing orientation that subordinates truth-supporting conditions to operative effect and can employ sophistry alongside many other mechanisms.

The conceptual nesting is therefore:

```
instrumental untruthfulness
├── direct and informational deception
├── semantic and rhetorical manipulation
├── sophistry
│   └── sophisms
├── dialogue manipulation
└── propaganda and systemic deployment
```

Sophisms should consequently not be added below as one more mechanism beside equivocation, presupposition smuggling, straw men, burden reversal, or motte-and-bailey shifts. They are a **cross-cutting, argument-shaped class** instantiated by many of those mechanisms. A mechanism becomes sophistical when it is incorporated into an apparently reasoned case whose concealed defect supplies its persuasive advantage.

2. Integrity dimensions

The inventory normalizes the mechanisms against nine dimensions developed during the private source-review process.

Code	Integrity dimension	Governing question
TI	Truth integrity	Are asserted propositions presented in accordance with the speaker's evidence and beliefs?
II	Information integrity	Is relevant information included rather than selectively withheld or flooded out?
RI	Relevance integrity	Does the response address the actual issue and evidence?
CI	Clarity integrity	Is the communication sufficiently clear to permit scrutiny?
SI	Sincerity integrity	Does public speech truthfully express what the speaker thinks?
MI	Meaning integrity	Are words used in shared, stable, and inspectable senses?
DI	Discussion integrity	Are the standpoint, burdens, reasons, and closure rules handled fairly?
LI	Dialogue integrity	Is the overt kind of conversation also the operative kind of conversation?
XI	Context/source integrity	Are origin, context, identity, and evidential status represented honestly?

These dimensions are diagnostic, not mutually exclusive boxes. One mechanism commonly violates several at once.

3. Inventory

A. Assertion and information selection

LT-001 — Direct falsification

- **Aliases:** lie by commission; false assertion.
- **Operation:** Assert as true a proposition the speaker believes to be false or inadequately supported.
- **Integrity:** TI, SI.
- **Status:** Established core category.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-002 — Omission and selective concealment

- **Aliases:** lie by omission; suppression; selective disclosure.
- **Operation:** Present a technically compatible fragment while withholding information needed to form the materially correct picture.
- **Integrity:** II, TI, SI.
- **Status:** Established core category.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-003 — Paltering and false implicature

- **Aliases:** misleading truth; deceptive implicature.
- **Operation:** Use literally true statements to induce a conclusion the speaker regards as false, retaining the escape that the false conclusion was never explicitly stated.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, SI.
- **Diagnostic:** Ask what a reasonable listener was meant to infer, not only what the sentence literally entailed.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-004 — Bullshit and evidential indifference

- **Aliases:** assertion without truth orientation; argumentative bullshit.
- **Operation:** Speak for impression, status, mobilization, or persuasion without treating the truth or falsity of the content as a governing constraint.
- **Integrity:** TI, SI.
- **Status:** Established category; distinct from a lie narrowly defined because knowledge of the truth need not guide the speaker.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-005 — Trade-off suppression

- **Aliases:** one-sided effect selection; effect/side-effect asymmetry.
- **Operation:** Describe only the desired effect or only the unwanted side effect of a measure, thereby concealing that action and inaction both involve benefits, costs, risks, and alternatives.
- **Integrity:** II, RI.
- **Status:** Project-developed term; the exact formulation was not located in the reviewed source material during this pass.
- **Diagnostic:** Require the same ledger—benefits, harms, uncertainty, alternatives, and opportunity costs—for favored and disfavored measures.

LT-006 — Information flooding

- **Aliases:** firehose of falsehood; attention saturation; epistemic overload.
- **Operation:** Produce claims at a volume and speed that exceeds the audience's capacity to test them, allowing important disagreements to drown in low-cost messages.
- **Integrity:** II, RI, TI.
- **Status:** Established propaganda family; also a bridge from individual speech acts to systemic lying.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

B. Meaning, implication, and framing

LT-007 — Equivocation and private-definition escape

- **Aliases:** semantic ambiguity; mental reservation; strategic polysemy.
- **Operation:** Exploit a word's different senses—or silently use a specialist/private sense—so the audience receives one meaning while the speaker later retreats to another.
- **Integrity:** MI, CI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-008 — Persuasive redefinition

- **Aliases:** persuasive definition; semantic extension or contraction; illegitimate extension of vocabulary; definitional drift.
- **Operation:** Preserve a word's favorable or condemnatory emotional force while changing the cases to which it applies. The inherited evaluation is transferred without having to justify it anew.
- **Integrity:** MI, DI.
- **Examples of form:** "True freedom is obedience"; expanding a grave term so that minor or disputed cases inherit its moral force.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-009 — Doublespeak and euphemistic inversion

- **Aliases:** semantic cosmetics; inverted meaning; bureaucratic euphemism.
- **Operation:** Rename an act so that its description obscures agency, cost, coercion, or moral character—or makes an adverse reality sound benign.
- **Integrity:** MI, CI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-042 — Newspeak-style vocabulary restriction

- **Source term:** **Newspeak**, from [George Orwell's *Nineteen Eighty-Four*](#).
- **Operation:** Deliberately reduce, prohibit, or institutionally displace words and distinctions needed to formulate, compare, or publicly circulate disfavoured propositions, thereby raising the cognitive and social cost of making the rival account explicit.
- **Integrity:** MI, CI, DI.
- **Boundary:** Newspeak is not an alias for doublespeak. Doublespeak obscures an act through a misleading expression; Newspeak-style restriction narrows the available expressive repertoire. Vocabulary always changes, terminological economy can clarify, and losing one word does not make a thought literally impossible. Diagnosis requires evidence of directional restriction, institutionally enforced replacement, or the systematic removal of distinctions needed for criticism.
- **Status:** Orwell's literary device is the source model; this entry extracts a bounded linguistic operation and does not claim strong linguistic determinism or empirical validation of the fictional system.

LT-010 — Presupposition smuggling

- **Aliases:** presupposition manipulation; loaded question; assumption smuggling.
- **Operation:** Encode a disputed proposition as already given rather than assert it openly, so accepting the grammatical frame silently concedes the point.
- **Integrity:** TI, MI, DI.
- **Diagnostic:** Extract every proposition that must already be true for the question or sentence to work.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-011 — Selective framing

- **Aliases:** frame control; aspect selection; interpretive steering.
- **Operation:** Select and emphasize aspects of reality so as to privilege a problem definition, causal account, moral evaluation, or remedy while rendering competing descriptions less visible.
- **Integrity:** II, RI; sometimes MI.

- **Boundary:** Framing is unavoidable; the trick lies in concealing consequential selections, excluding rival frames, or presenting a contestable frame as reality itself.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-043 — Pseudo-metric predication

- **Aliases:** metric-form language without metric content; simulated assessment; verdictive pseudo-measurement.
- **Operation:** Attach comparative, threshold, or evaluative language to an object without supplying a stable operational rule capable of determining whether the predicate applies. The expression thereby makes an unexposed judgment sound like the result of measurement or an independently applied classification.
- **Canonical compression:** **There may be no hidden ruler. The language merely imitates the authority of having used a ruler.**
- **Characteristic forms:** *significant biodiversity value, adequate ecological integrity, unacceptable biodiversity loss*, or parallel phrases in which *significant, adequate, unacceptable, meaningful, balanced, or representative* appears to report a crossed threshold without identifying the threshold or rule.
- **Operation sequence:**
 - underspecified object
 - + measurement-like or threshold predicate
 - + institutional or expert authority
 - apparent factual assessment
 - unexposed evaluative verdict
 - presupposed deficit
 - permission to intervene
- **Integrity:** MI, II, CI, DI; sometimes LI.
- **Diagnostic:** Ask the speaker to decompress the predicate into its object, dimension, baseline, comparison class, spatial and temporal scale, threshold or qualitative decision rule, evidence rule, uncertainty treatment, conflict rule, and possible defeater or completion condition. Then test whether independent reviewers can understand the application, whether comparable cases receive comparable treatment, and whether counterevidence and appeal can change the verdict.
- **Relation to metric custody:** An explicit metric discloses its operational rule. A tacit criterion has a stable operational rule in professional convention, guidance, precedent, or practice but withholds it from public inspection. Pseudo-metric predication is the stricter third case: no stable ruler may exist. If implementation later reveals a stable internal rule, the case becomes tacit criterion custody. If officials decide case by case, it remains interpreter custody and authorization without specification, which can feed discretionary policy custody.
- **Relation to the model-to-mandate chain:** When an inspectable metric and real model do exist, this trick may not be present. The audit must instead test construct validity, decision-scale model adequacy, causal-harm translation, protected-principal valuation, severity threshold, remedy comparison, authorization, and outcome correction separately. The generic [model-to-mandate custody chain](#) prevents the prestige of a valid early stage from laundering unargued later crossings. Conversely, a disputed later crossing does not show that the measurement or model is false.
- **Related operations:** LT-040 supplies the recognition cues of assessment without the corresponding function; LT-010 can presuppose that a relevant threshold has been crossed; LT-008 can transfer the authority of a valued term; LT-011 can hide competing dimensions and trade-offs; and LT-041 can conceal the implementing powers and sacrifices. When observed or predicted *change* is called *deterioration*, the [Hanekamp–Wegner bridge](#) tests the intervening relevant-structure and moral-appraisal step; the word is not pseudo-metric merely because it is evaluative.
- **PCP routing:** At [Perception](#), the predicate reports that a condition has supposedly been identified; at Context, it classifies that condition as a relevant deficit; at Permission, it helps authorize the guardian, expert, or institution to impose the apparently required remedy. The route is a diagnostic reconstruction, not proof that every use was designed in those stages.
- **Boundary:** Numbers are neither necessary nor sufficient. A nonnumerical, open-textured, or expert criterion is not pseudo-metric when its purpose, factors, boundaries, evidence, reasons, and revision or appeal route

are sufficiently inspectable. Nor is every shorthand phrase manipulative. Classification strengthens when the expression itself is treated as sufficient evidence for binding action, resists decompression, substitutes asymmetrically for reasons, or remains insulated from correction.

- **General-mechanism relation:** *Mythology Construction*, “*Metric custody in more detail*” owns the constructed-mapping and custody mechanism; this inventory owns the observable communicative operation.
- **Status:** Project-developed compound operation extracted from the Humanism–Diversity, metric-custody, and silent-principal analysis. It names the communicative operation, not a finding about any phrase, field, speaker, or institution merely because measurement language is used.

LT-012 — Outcome relabeling

- **Aliases:** terminus relabeling; “true X” maneuver; procedural-value substitution.
- **Operation:** Stretch a procedural or contestable value into an absolute, declare existing practices counterfeit, then reserve the value’s name for the speaker’s preferred outcome—for example, defining democracy as the policy that “the people truly want.”
- **Integrity:** MI, DI, LI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-013 — Benevolent-language camouflage

- **Aliases:** care-speak; safety camouflage; coercion-as-care; convenience rhetoric.
- **Operation:** Describe expanding control, penalties, dependence, or loss of exit in the language of care, concern, safety, support, and convenience, thereby borrowing benevolent intent as a shield against structural examination.
- **Integrity:** MI, II, LI.
- **Boundary:** Benevolent language is not evidence of concealed coercion. The diagnostic is whether contestability, reversibility, and exit disappear behind it.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-014 — Dog-whistle double address

- **Aliases:** coded appeal; dual-audience messaging.
- **Operation:** Use an expression with an innocuous public reading and a second, group-coded reading, enabling mobilization of insiders alongside deniability to outsiders.
- **Integrity:** MI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-015 — Diffamatory fighting term

- **Original term:** *diffamierender Kampfbegriff*.
- **Operation:** Attach a negatively charged label to a person, group, or idea so moral rejection occurs before factual examination; justification is replaced by moral marking.
- **Integrity:** RI, MI, DI.
- **Status:** User-selected compound term.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-016 — Symbol displacement

- **Original term:** *Symbolverschiebung*.
- **Operation:** Turn a neutral or minor object into the emotionally charged proxy for a diffuse conflict; shared rejection of the proxy synchronizes a group and substitutes symbolic hostility for examination of the underlying issue.
- **Integrity:** RI, II; sometimes MI.
- **Boundary:** This can emerge collectively without a designing speaker; it is therefore also a culture mechanism, not only a deliberate trick.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-O44 — Deconstructive reversal

- **Originating compression:** “Push the center to the periphery and the periphery into the center.”
- **Operation:** Expose and morally redescribe a center–periphery hierarchy, downgrade the incumbent center as derivative, oppressive, exclusionary, or obstructive, grant the formerly peripheral term privileged standing, and reinterpret the former center through the new center.
- **Generic sequence:**
 - identify incumbent center
 - identify excluded or subordinated periphery
 - explain the center as dependent upon suppression of the periphery
 - morally reverse the hierarchy
 - make the former periphery the privileged standpoint or sacred principal
 - reinterpret the former center through the new center
- **Integrity:** MI, II, DI; sometimes RI or LI.
- **Diagnostic:** Identify the original opposition, the evidence for actual subordination, the rule that transfers standing, which functions or goods of the old center survive, whether the former margin has become a new self-exempting center, and which affected persons gain or lose standing, jurisdiction, refusal, or appeal. Distinguish correction of a false hierarchy from installation of an inverted hierarchy.
- **Relation to mythology replacement:** The operation can help unbraid an incumbent mythology by withdrawing sacred or explanatory priority from its center and making its formerly marginal term available for successor rebraiding. In the [Humanism–Diversity application](#), expansion from the universe of humans toward ecological, cultural, and identity difference does not itself perform the reversal. Reversal requires the further displacement in which the former human center loses governing standing and the selected peripheral pattern acquires it.
- **Boundary:** This is the project’s selected name for a bounded operation, not a summary definition of Derrida or deconstruction as a whole. A fuller deconstructive double movement can also destabilize the reversed opposition rather than installing the former margin as a new center. The entry establishes no Derridean genealogy, conscious plan, manipulative intent, or moral valence. A reversal can expose a real exclusion, correct unjustified privilege, broaden standing, produce a mixed or supplementary order, install a new domination, or fail.
- **Related operations:** LT-O11 can hide the selection of center and margin; LT-O08 can transfer inherited moral force to the successor term; LT-O13 can supply a benevolent wrapper; LT-O40 can substitute recognition cues for function; and LT-O41 can omit the successor’s operational mechanism, jurisdiction, and burdens. None is entailed by reversal.
- **Status:** User-selected project expression developed from a remembered popular compression of deconstruction. The normalized definition, sequence, diagnostic, Humanism–Diversity application, and boundaries are Culture Mechanics developments. The remembered formulation is a source lead, not a verified quotation from Derrida.

C. Diversion and corruption of discussion

LT-O17 — Quibbling and irrelevant precision

- **Aliases:** hairsplitting; trivial objection; pedantic derailment.
- **Operation:** Focus scrutiny on a minor ambiguity, exception, or wording defect that does not materially affect the disputed claim, creating the appearance of refutation while avoiding its substance.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-O18 — Redirection

- **Aliases:** red herring; whataboutism; topic diversion; evasion.
- **Operation:** Replace the proposition under examination with another subject, comparison, accusation, or question that is easier or more advantageous to discuss.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI.
- **Diagnostic:** Restate the original proposition and ask whether the response changes its evidential status.

- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-019 — Psychologizing Bulverism

- **Original term:** *psychologisierender Bulverismus*.
- **Operation:** Evade examination of a thesis by presupposing it false and explaining instead which motive, pathology, identity, or defect allegedly caused the speaker to believe it.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI, TI.
- **Related but distinct:** ad hominem, genetic fallacy, motive fallacy, presupposition smuggling.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-020 — Standpoint substitution

- **Aliases:** straw man; misrepresentation; attributed-position drift.
- **Operation:** Replace an opponent's actual position with a weaker, more extreme, or more morally objectionable one and refute the substitute.
- **Integrity:** DI, TI, RI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-021 — Caricature-demonic phantom-enemy distortion

- **Original term:** *karikaturdämonisches Phantomfeind-Zerrbild als Hassfigur*.
- **Operation:** Construct a grossly exaggerated, morally demonized opponent from selected and invented attributes, then make this phantom a collective hate object. It is a socially elaborated straw man whose function includes affective mobilization and group identity.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI, DI.
- **Status:** User-developed compound term.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-022 — Burden reversal and immunization

- **Aliases:** burden shifting; unfalsifiable retreat; proof-demand asymmetry.
- **Operation:** Demand that critics disprove an unsupported claim, or continually alter what would count as counterevidence, insulating the favored position from the obligations imposed on alternatives.
- **Integrity:** DI, TI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-023 — Closure sabotage

- **Aliases:** moving the goalposts; false declaration of victory; refusal to concede.
- **Operation:** Change success criteria after evidence arrives, refuse the consequences of a defeated claim, or declare resolution without answering the decisive objection.
- **Integrity:** DI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-024 — Covert dialogue-type switch

- **Original umbrella:** *Dialogintegritätsverletzung*.
- **Operation:** Ostensibly participate in inquiry or critical discussion while covertly operating by the rules of another dialogue—personal quarrel, negotiation, propaganda, interrogation, or audience performance.
- **Integrity:** LI, DI, SI.
- **Example:** A request to examine evidence becomes an occasion to diagnose the questioner or signal loyalty to spectators.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-025 — Reversible blockade

- **Original term:** *Reversible Blockade*.

- **Operation:** Assert an extreme opposite of the truth so emphatically that an audience disposed toward moderation searches for a midpoint and lands at a conclusion still displaced from reality in the manipulator's preferred direction.
- **Integrity:** TI, DI, MI.
- **Status:** Project-developed term; the exact phrase was not located in the reviewed source material during this pass.
- **Related mechanisms:** anchoring, false balance, midpoint fallacy, strategic polarization.

LT-026 — Person/group substitution by neologism

- **Prompting example:** *Zufallsmehrheiten*.
- **Operation:** Introduce a novel label that redirects attention from the substantive issue to the character or composition of persons and groups, allowing the original subject to remain unexamined.
- **Integrity:** RI, MI.
- **Status:** Provisional project reconstruction; the exact term was not located in the reviewed source material during this pass. More source context is needed before treating it as a settled independent type.

D. Moral attribution and enemy construction

Working heuristic — The iron law of ideological projection The **iron law of ideological projection** is the working heuristic that the less a closed ideological formation can acknowledge and correct its own discrediting motives, practices, and intentions, the more strongly it tends to attribute them to its opponents.

This is a proposed culture-mechanical principle, not an established scientific law. It generalizes the source-attested partisan expression “The Iron Law of Woke Projection” into a structurally neutral term. “Iron law” denotes a recurrent tendency, not an exceptionless rule.

It must not be converted into the claim that every accusation is a confession. That would itself become a sophism: the origin of an accusation would replace examination of its evidence. Every accusation must still be evaluated on its own evidence.

The heuristic contains several increasingly specific phenomena:

- **Psychological projection:** attributing one's characteristics, affects, impulses, or responsibilities to another; it can be unconscious and nonstrategic.
- **Negative total projection:** transferring a generalized inventory of disowned badness to the enemy.
- **Accusation in a Mirror:** attributing one's particular act or intention to the prospective victim.
- **Moral inversion:** more broadly reversing aggressor/defender, responsible party/victim, or good/evil roles.
- **DARVO:** the reactive sequence of denial, attack, and victim–offender reversal.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-027 — Accusation in a Mirror

- **Aliases:** AiM; mirror politics; mirror accusation; *Spiegelbeschuldigung*.
- **Functional description:** preventive blame reversal; *präventive Schuldumkehr*.
- **Operation:** Attribute one's own intended or ongoing aggression to the opponent so that one's aggression can be interpreted in advance as defensive necessity.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI.
- **Functions:** Preemptive attribution, moral disinhibition, information fog, reaction delay, pretext formation, and plausible deniability.
- **Specialized neighboring term:** *Human-rights inversion* is used for related inversions in international human-rights discourse.
- **Distinction:** AiM is narrower than psychological projection and moral inversion. It specifically mirrors the actor's own conduct or intention and is commonly pre-emptive.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-028 — Positive moral appropriation

- **Aliases:** moral transfer; co-option; glittering generality; strategic mimicry.
- **Operation:** Appropriately the respected symbols, achievements, virtues, or vocabulary of another tradition or group without accepting the practices that earned their positive standing.

- **Integrity:** XI, MI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-029 — Strategic moral reattribution

- **Original term:** *moralische Attributionsverschiebung*.
- **Operation:** Transfer one's own negative characteristics to the opponent while transferring the opponent's or a respected third party's positive characteristics to oneself. The combined operation performs a rhetorical "moral balance-sheet cleanup."
- **Negative subtype: Negative total projection** (*negative Totalprojektion*) attributes a broad inventory of the actor's or in-group's disowned vices to the enemy. Unlike strict AiM, it need not mirror one particular act or intention.
- **Positive subtype:** Positive moral appropriation transfers another party's virtues, achievements, symbols, or benevolent intentions to the in-group.
- **Integrity:** TI, XI, SI.
- **Status:** Synthetic family joining LT-027 and LT-028.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-030 — Comparison destruction and moral leveling

- **Original term:** *moralische Nivellierung*.
- **Aliases:** false equivalence; universalized cynicism; epistemic fog.
- **Operation:** When favorable comparison is no longer credible, make distinctions between better and worse appear unknowable or irrelevant: "everyone lies," "all sides are equally corrupt."
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI.
- **Effect:** Moral fatigue suppresses discriminating judgment without rehabilitating the discredited actor on the facts.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-031 — Protection blackmail

- **Original term:** *Schutz-Erpressung*.
- **Operation:** Admit or normalize one's own harms while claiming that only submission to the harmful actor prevents an even worse enemy: "we may be harsh, but we are all that protects you."
- **Integrity:** II, RI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-032 — Reality-free escalation of invective

- **Original coined label:** *political Tourette syndrome*.
- **Project-developed mechanism name:** **projective-vandalism circuit.**
- **Operation:** Emit a continuous stream of increasingly grave accusations and taboo-laden insults with little evidential constraint, gaining affective force from the extremity of the vocabulary and from the strike against the symbolically stained target.
- **Originating sequence:** **Externalize the blemish → strike the blemish → enjoy the strike.**
- **Candidate operation sequence:**
 - disowned blemish
 - project it onto an opponent
 - mark the opponent with nuclear taboo vocabulary
 - create a morally attackable target surface
 - symbolically vandalize the target
 - receive audience resonance and possible surplus jouissance
 - repeat or escalate independently of reality
- **Functions:** Enemy construction, moral disinhibition, symbolic-face damage, audience synchronization, boundary signaling, and repetitive transgressive reward.

- **Distinctions:** Ordinary character assassination is primarily instrumental reputation destruction. Accusation in a Mirror pre-emptively attributes a particular intended or ongoing aggression to its prospective victim. Negative total projection supplies a generalized inventory of disowned badness. The projective-vandalism circuit identifies the repeated, affectively rewarded strike that can continue after factual or strategic utility has decayed.
- **Evidentiary boundary:** A hostile third-party label such as “Nazi” directly establishes that the accusation was made, not that the target instantiates the category. Nor does an unsupported or false accusation prove projection or confession by itself. The target classification and any projection hypothesis require independent evidence. See the [Attribution-Source Asymmetry](#).
- **Motivational status:** The surplus-jouissance interpretation is a proposed mechanism, not an observation licensed by vocabulary alone. Strategic signaling, anger, conformity, media incentives, and ordinary reputation warfare remain alternatives. The motivational account belongs to [Mythology Construction](#).
- **Integrity:** TI, RI, MI.
- **Naming caution:** The original label is metaphorical, not clinical, and risks stigmatizing a neurological condition. The descriptive heading above is preferred for the inventory.
- **Status:** Originating pattern and sequence, joined to a project-developed observable-operation model; not an established clinical or causal syndrome.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-033 — Script-forming threat preactivation

- **Original term:** *skriptbildende Voraktivierung*.
- **Operation:** Repeatedly narrate the opponent as an imminent aggressor so a later ambiguous event is automatically recognized through the prepared script: their act is attack; ours is defense.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI.
- **Status:** Primarily a downstream cognitive and social effect of repeated AiM, but retained because it explains why the linguistic operation matters over time.
- **Terminological boundary:** *Script* here means a preactivated interpretive sequence for classifying a later event. It is narrower than the [situated-cultural-script](#) construct, which joins a general cultural weave to distributed roles, routines, interfaces, improvisation, and practical support.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-038 — DARVO

- **Expansion:** Deny, Attack, and Reverse Victim and Offender.
- **German description:** denial, counterattack, and *Täter-Opfer-Umkehr*.
- **Operation:** When confronted with alleged wrongdoing, deny the conduct, attack the accuser or their credibility, and recast the accused party as the real victim and the confronting party as the offender.
- **Integrity:** TI, RI, DI, LI.
- **Distinction from AiM:** AiM is commonly pre-emptive and prepares aggression as defense. DARVO is commonly reactive and protects an actor from accountability after confrontation.
- **Relation to moral inversion:** The final DARVO stage is a form of moral inversion or *Täter-Opfer-Umkehr*, but DARVO names the complete three-stage sequence.
- **Status:** Established term.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-039 — Moralized character accusation

- **Source term:** Michael Andrick’s account of *Moralisierung* in [Im Moralegefängnis: Spaltung verstehen und überwinden](#).
- **Operation:** Move the focus from the disputed issue to the other person’s character and the dialogue mode from inquiry to accusation. Reinterpret a statement, omission, association, missing conformity signal, imposed marker, or attributed target label as a revealing disclosure of character, then use that accusation to attack the person’s standing or eligibility to participate.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI, LI.

- **Status:** Borrowed from Andrick and operationalized for this inventory; the culture-mechanical field extension is project-developed.
- **Related but distinct:** psychologizing Bulverism, redirection, covert dialogue-type switch, defamatory moral marking, and legitimate evidence-based judgment of conduct.
- **Systemic extension:** The complete signal-character accusation-exclusion-enforcement mechanism and Andrick's category of discursive violence are developed in *Culture Mechanics*; they are not reduced here to a linguistic trick.

LT-040 — Cue-function substitution (*Wie-Was manipulation*)

- **Source term:** Dushan Wegner's *Wie-Was-Manipulation in Relevante Strukturen* (2019).
- **Aliases:** recognition-cue substitution; cue-function mismatch; moral camouflage.
- **Operation:** Supply the learned perceptible cues by which an audience recognizes a valued category while the underlying operation, structure, or consequences that make the category applicable are absent, materially weaker, or opposed. The *Wie* is the recognition route; the *Was* is what the category is meant to identify.
- **Integrity:** MI, II, RI; sometimes SI.
- **Examples of the general form:** visible moral vocabulary without the corresponding conduct; credentials or institutional form without the claimed function; symbolic compliance that substitutes for the result the symbol is supposed to indicate; camouflage or decoys that elicit a learned recognition response.
- **Diagnostic:** Specify the claimed category and its constitutive function, list the cues that activated recognition, inspect actual operation and consequences, and observe what happens when cue and function are compared openly.
- **Boundary:** Every practical category relies on fallible cues and proxies. Cue-function mismatch can arise through error, changed conditions, Goodhart-like drift, or an obsolete classification rule. Manipulation is a stronger inference requiring evidence such as strategic production of the cue, recurrent asymmetry, concealment of function, or resistance to consequence-based correction.
- **Status:** Wegner's distinction is retained in his language and operationalized here as a cross-domain diagnostic. It overlaps benevolent-language camouflage, ideological symbols, paramorality, and qualified-concept inversion without being reducible to any one of them.

LT-041 — Doctrinal causal omission

- **Aliases:** semantic-wrapper / operational-payload concealment; undisclosed implementation; CPU-bigOther split address.
- **Operation:** Present an attractive explicit doctrine to reflective cognition while withholding a material affective, social, or institutional mechanism on which the doctrine's constructor or operator relies to produce its foreseeable practical effect. The hearer is invited to assent to the semantic wrapper without being given the bigOther-facing or institutional payload needed to evaluate the actual programme.
- **Integrity:** II, SI, MI, LI; sometimes TI.
- **Diagnostic:** State the public principles, reconstruct the expected recipient classifications and emotions, identify the implementing offices, sanctions, dependencies, and authority relations, then compare those layers with plans, training, audience segmentation, private predictions, and observed descendants. Ask whether disclosure would predictably change reasonable assent.
- **Responsibility gradient:** intentional concealed construction → knowing omission → reckless omission → negligent blindness → unforeseeable emergence.
- **Boundary:** No finite doctrine can state every causal consequence, and social effects often emerge without a designer. A wrapper-payload mismatch establishes a question, not a lie. The stronger verdict **doctrinal lying by omission** requires evidence of knowledge or sufficiently culpable foreseeability, materiality, non-disclosure, and reliance on the omitted mechanism.
- **Related but distinct:** LT-002 concerns selective concealment generally; LT-013 camouflages control in benevolent language; LT-014 sends coded meanings to different audiences; LT-040 substitutes recognition cues for function. LT-041 specifically conceals the causal implementation that joins a public doctrine to its expected cultural and institutional outcome.
- **Primary semantic home:** *Mythology Construction*, "Doctrinal progeny, generative spirit, and responsibility".
- **Status:** Project-developed communicative operation extracted from the doctrinal-progeny and concealed-causal-design analysis.

E. Agenda, representation, and policy coupling

LT-034 — Pretext trap of the harmful fix

- **Original term:** *Vorwandfalle der Schadlösung*.
- **Operation:** Use a real problem as the pretext for a preselected measure presented as its solution even though the measure foreseeably preserves or worsens that problem.
- **Component operations:** Problem surfing, a causal story serving as a pretextual bridge, argumentative coupling, and concealment of the harmful or placebo character of the remedy.
- **Integrity:** II, RI, TI, LI.
- **Status:** User-selected term.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-035 — Ventriloquism of constituencies

- **Aliases:** self-appointed representation; constructed-interest speech; speaking for “the people.”
- **Operation:** Construct a group’s interests and speak authoritatively in its name without authorization, internal plurality, or a route by which members can contradict the attributed voice.
- **Integrity:** XI, SI, DI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-036 — Motte-and-bailey amplitude shift

- **Aliases:** mobilizing maximalism / scrutinized minimalism.
- **Operation:** Use a sweeping structural claim when mobilizing support, then retreat under criticism to a narrow technical claim; after scrutiny passes, return to the expansive implication.
- **Integrity:** TI, MI, DI.
- **Diagnostic:** Require one stable statement of the claim, its scope, and its proposed consequences across audiences.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-037 — Context and source manipulation

- **Aliases:** false context; imposter content; manipulated content; information laundering.
- **Operation:** Preserve or fabricate content while falsifying who produced it, where it appeared, when it applied, or what evidential standing it has. Apparent provenance substitutes for argument.
- **Integrity:** XI, TI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

4. Important boundaries

Honest error is not insincerity

A person can sincerely state a false belief, and can insincerely repeat a proposition that happens to be true. Sincerity and reality-tracking are distinct dimensions. The first constitutional step is to make it safe and normal for people to say what they actually think; only then can open disagreement test how well those beliefs track reality.

Semantic disagreement is not necessarily manipulation

Some disputes are genuinely verbal: participants attach different meanings to the same word. Clarifying definitions can dissolve confusion without establishing deceit. A reviewed private source supplies the relevant boundary case: shared definition repair is the remedy, whereas covertly changing a definition while retaining its emotional force is LT-008.

At society scale, persistent divergence can contribute to **intergroup semantic decoupling** and eventually **cultural interoperability breakdown (Babelization)** even when no speaker is manipulating anyone. That is a systemic condition, not a linguistic trick. Shared definition repair, trusted translation, and legitimate common procedures can increase the effective thickness or span of lifted solidarity without requiring identical first-order meanings. [Mythology Construction, “Cultural interoperability and its breakdown \(Babelization\)”](#) defines that larger condition and its anti-Babel floor.

Framing and conceptual engineering are not inherently dishonest

All finite descriptions select aspects of reality, and communities sometimes need better concepts. Manipulation begins when consequential selection or revision is hidden, rival descriptions are excluded from consideration, or the revised concept is represented as the word's uncontested natural meaning.

A recognition cue is not automatically a counterfeit

Language, credentials, symbols, institutional forms, and behavioural markers are often indispensable evidence of an otherwise difficult-to-observe function. LT-040 does not license the inference that every proxy is fraudulent. Its target is the inspectable mismatch between cue and function and, when manipulation is alleged, the further evidence that the mismatch was strategically produced, concealed, or immunized against correction.

Open-textured judgment is not automatically pseudo-measurement

Many legitimate decisions cannot be reduced to one number. Law, medicine, engineering, ecology, and ordinary practical judgment use qualitative standards, professional interpretation, and revisable boundary judgments. LT-043 does not require false precision or prohibit such judgment. It asks whether an apparently assessed predicate has an inspectable operational basis, exposes the human choice within it, and remains answerable to evidence, comparable cases, reasons, affected persons, review, and appeal. The absence of numbers is not the failure; the performance of measurement-authority without an operationally contestable judgment is.

The legal analogue likewise requires a strict separation:

vague or open-textured legal language
≠ surrogate rule-making or judicial activism
≠ adjudication serving the interpreter's group interest

Open texture can be unavoidable and can transparently delegate bounded judgment. It becomes an interpreter-custody affordance when the prospective rule leaves an operative classification, exception, or conflict rule unresolved. Surrogate rule-making is the further institutional operation in which a judge, regulator, commission, or administrator effectively supplies or varies that rule beyond its constituted jurisdiction. Group-interest adjudication is a still further motive, beneficiary, or capture attribution requiring independent evidence. The [Sowell legal-surrogate branch](#) owns the complete sequence, comparative correction audit, and boundaries.

This is not necessarily LT-043. It becomes pseudo-metric predication only where measurement-like or threshold language presents a contestable classification as though an operational assessment had already delivered it. Otherwise the appropriate diagnosis may be ordinary legal interpretation, disclosed delegation, tacit criterion custody, authorization without specification, or case-level interpreter custody.

An omitted mechanism is not automatically a lie

Complex doctrines cannot enumerate every psychological, institutional, and historical condition of implementation. LT-041 requires a material gap between the offered reason for assent and an operational mechanism on which the constructor relies. Intentional or knowing concealment, private causal prediction, audience engineering, repeated adverse offspring, and refusal to disclose after the mechanism becomes visible strengthen the diagnosis. Mere hindsight does not.

A fallacy is not automatically a lie

Bad reasoning can arise from haste, ignorance, motivated cognition, or honest confusion. A fallacy therefore becomes a sophism only when its plausibility is used to conceal or exploit the defect in the argument. This inventory classifies communicative operations, not the speaker's inaccessible inner intent. Evidence of a pattern, asymmetrical application, strategic retreat, resistance to correction, or concealed dialogue purpose strengthens an inference of sophisticated or otherwise instrumental use.

Effects are not always tricks

Symbol displacement, pluralistic ignorance, moral fatigue, and script preactivation can emerge through distributed repetition without a central designer. They belong here where they explain how repeated speech acts become a culture mechanism, but they should not be mistaken for proof of an individual plot.

5. Relation to the epistemic constitution

This inventory is not primarily a blacklist of forbidden expressions. In a reality-anchored, truth-seeking epistemic constitution it supplies a common vocabulary—a yardstick installed in the social *big Other*—for noticing when communication departs from truth-seeking.

The entries identify local operations; *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, “Audience-modelled reconstruction and decompression” supplies a cross-cutting model of how several such operations can be combined against an anticipated recipient so that the recipient reconstructs a targeted factual, causal, moral, or authorization model.

Several operations can also be assembled into **un-reason**: reasoning continues, but semantic distinctions, evidential burdens, exceptions, and replies to criticism are recursively arranged to keep a protected account from losing. Un-reason is not another LT entry. It is a wider inferential and institutional mechanism that sophistry, burden reversal, immunization, framing, or dialogue corruption may help implement. One fallacy, contested definition, or linguistic trick does not establish it.

The inventory also keeps Orwell’s two neighbouring mechanisms distinct. **Newspeak-style vocabulary restriction** changes the available symbolic repertoire. **Doublethink** allows incompatible beliefs to coexist, remain compartmentalized, or switch with authority without their contradiction correcting the account. The former is a linguistic operation; the latter is a cognitive and potentially institutional mechanism. Either can support un-reason or systemic lying, but neither entails the other and neither is established by one euphemism or contradiction.

The corresponding positive virtues are:

1. State what one actually believes and distinguish belief from knowledge.
2. Check simple factual claims before amplifying them.
3. Present material counterevidence, trade-offs, and uncertainty.
4. Keep meanings explicit, shared, and corrigible.
5. Represent an opponent’s actual strongest position.
6. Answer the proposition before discussing the speaker.
7. Apply comparable evidential burdens to allies and opponents.
8. Keep the kind and rules of the dialogue visible.
9. Preserve provenance and context.
10. Permit correction without making honest concession socially ruinous.
11. Test identity-bearing and moral recognition cues against actual function and consequences.
12. Compare CPU-facing principles with the affective and institutional mechanisms expected to implement them.
13. Decompress apparently measured predicates into their object, rule, evidence, threshold or boundary, trade-offs, defeaters, and appeal route.
14. When a center–periphery reversal is proposed, disclose the selection and standing rule, preserve justified functions, and subject the successor center to the same evidential, jurisdictional, and person-protecting constraints.

The inventory’s function is thus constitutional and formative: it helps individuals recognize and resist small acts of public untruthfulness, while their repeated resistance changes the public norm that subsequently forms other individuals.

6. Provenance and limitations

This version was produced through structured review of private project source material, vocabulary expansion, contextual reading, synonym normalization, and boundary auditing. Source filenames, links, conversation identifiers, and internal prompt logs are intentionally withheld from this publication.

LT-039, LT-040, and LT-041 are explicit exceptions to that private discovery route. LT-039 was added from Michael Andrick’s book material and linked directly to the underlying publication. LT-040 was added from Dushan Wegner’s *Relevante Strukturen* (2019, ISBN 978-3-7394-0563-6), whose *Wie–Was* distinction is retained while the operational test and boundary are project-developed. LT-041 was developed in this project from the doctrinal-progeny analysis. Its originating contribution supplied the CPU-facing and bigOther-facing contrast; the inventory supplies the normalized operation, responsibility gradient, and evidential boundary.

This is a high-recall working inventory, not a claim of semantic exhaustiveness. The reviewed source collection is large, the same mechanism may have been discussed without any of the recovered names, and several private sources contain long embedded source texts. Future revisions should add newly found mechanisms only after checking

whether they are genuinely distinct operations or aliases, combinations, effects, and institutional deployments of types already recorded here.

The labels *Reversive Blockade* and *Zufallsmehrheiten* were developed during the private source-review process but were not found verbatim in the reviewed materials during this pass. They are deliberately retained with provisional provenance rather than silently attributed to a source document.